



LANGUAGE POLICY AT SÚKROMNÉ GYMNÁZIUM ČESKÁ, 2026-2027



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School language profile

The language of instruction at the school is English. The school offers a range of language courses within the IB Diploma Programme to support both native and non-native speakers.

In **Group 1 (Language A: Studies in Language and Literature)**, students may study Slovak A: Literature (SL), English A: Language and Literature (SL/HL), or opt for school-supported self-taught languages (SL) to maintain and develop their mother tongue.

In **Group 2 (Language Acquisition)**, the school offers English B (SL/HL), German B (SL), and Spanish ab initio (SL).

Other languages may be studied online through Pamoja Education.

The school community is highly multicultural and multilingual, with students from diverse linguistic and cultural backgrounds, including Slovak, Russian, Chinese, Arabic, Ukrainian, Kazakh, Jewish, Armenian, British, Australian, and others.

The school promotes multilingualism and intercultural understanding in line with the philosophy of the International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme and supports students in developing strong communication skills across languages.

Students in lower grades are prepared for bilingual and IB studies through CLIL (Content and Language Integrated Learning) and an intensive English programme.

In MYP3 (Grade 9), students have up to 13 English lessons per week, reduced to a minimum of 5 in later years. Preparation also includes reading English literature, Public Speaking with a native speaker, Cultural Studies (The English-Speaking World), and trips including weekly language courses to England, Ireland, Malta, Spain, and Germany from the age of 11.

Admission to the bilingual department or Middle Years Programme (MYP3) requires entrance examinations in Slovak, English, and Mathematics, with a minimum English level of B1.

School Mission Statement

Our school strives to consistently deliver highly educated young citizens to our ever-changing multi-cultural society prepared to proactively play their parts in a promising new world.

We carefully balance a positive atmosphere with challenging goals, an international curriculum and assessment thereby inspiring the student to create a brighter future through diligence and lifelong learning.



School's language philosophy

We aim to develop students who embody the attributes of the International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme Learner Profile: knowledgeable, balanced, reflective, principled, open-minded, caring, communicators, inquirers, and risk-takers.

The school affirms that language, multilingualism, and multiculturalism are fundamental to student achievement and to the development of SGČ as an international learning community.

At SGČ, multilingualism and the development of critical literacy are regarded as essential in fostering international mindedness through the promotion of cultural identity, intercultural awareness, and global citizenship.

It is also a core principle of the school that all students should have the opportunity to maintain and develop their mother tongue(s). The acquisition of additional languages further enables students to critically reflect upon and engage with diverse cultural perspectives.

Our Guiding Principles

This language policy is informed by the *Programme Standards and Practices (2020)* developed by the International Baccalaureate (IBO). It reflects the expectations for IB World Schools and aligns with the prescribed practices for teaching, learning and school culture.

Language is fundamental to learning, identity and intercultural understanding. As an IB Diploma Programme school, we believe that all teachers are language teachers and all students are language learners.

1. Commitment to multilingualism

(Aligned with: Culture 2.1)

We promote and value multilingualism as a core element of international-mindedness. Students are encouraged to develop proficiency in multiple languages and to use language as a tool for communication, learning and global engagement.

2. Respect for mother tongue and identity

(Aligned with: Culture 2.2)

We recognize that a student's first language is central to their cognitive development and cultural identity. We actively support the maintenance and development of students' home languages.

3. Language as a shared responsibility

(Aligned with: Learning 3.1)

Language development is the responsibility of all teachers across all subject areas. Every teacher supports students in developing subject-specific academic language and communication



skills.

4. Equity and access to learning

(Aligned with: Culture 2.4, Learning 3.2)

We ensure that all students, including those learning in a language other than their first language, are supported through appropriate differentiation and scaffolding so they can fully access the Diploma Programme curriculum.

5. Language-rich learning environment

(Aligned with: Learning 3.1, Learning 3.3)

We create a learning environment where language is visible, valued and actively developed through inquiry, collaboration and critical thinking across the curriculum.

6. Inclusive communication

(Aligned with: Culture 2.3)

We promote clear and inclusive communication within the school community, ensuring that students, parents and stakeholders can access essential information.

7. Development of academic language

(Aligned with: Learning 3.3)

We support students in developing the academic language and communication skills necessary for success in the Diploma Programme and beyond.

8. Fair and meaningful assessment

(Aligned with: Learning 3.4)

Assessment practices allow students to demonstrate their understanding while taking into account their language development needs, without compromising academic standards.

9. Ongoing reflection and improvement

(Aligned with: Culture 2.1)

Language and the Learner Profile

In alignment with the philosophy of the International Baccalaureate, the school recognizes that language is central to the development of the IB Learner Profile and to the cultivation of internationally minded individuals. Language underpins all learning and is the primary means through which students construct meaning, express understanding and engage with the world.

The school places particular emphasis on the development of **communicators**, ensuring that students are able to express themselves confidently, accurately and appropriately in more than one language and across a range of contexts. Students are explicitly taught to listen actively and to engage constructively with the perspectives of others.

Language learning supports the development of **open-minded** learners by enabling students to encounter and appreciate diverse cultural perspectives. The school affirms the importance of



students' mother tongues and actively promotes their maintenance and development alongside the acquisition of additional languages, thereby strengthening intercultural understanding.

Through structured inquiry and engagement with a wide range of texts, students develop as **thinkers and inquirers**, using language to analyze, evaluate and synthesize information. The school ensures that students are consistently provided with opportunities to formulate questions, construct reasoned arguments and engage in critical reflection.

Language is recognized as the vehicle through which students become **knowledgeable**, facilitating access to disciplinary content and enabling the articulation and transfer of understanding across subject areas. All teachers explicitly support the development of subject-specific academic language.

The school promotes the development of **principled** and **caring** individuals by fostering responsible and ethical use of language. Students are guided to communicate with integrity, respect and empathy in all interactions.

Furthermore, the school supports students in becoming **reflective** learners by providing structured opportunities for self-expression, goal setting and evaluation. Students are encouraged to take risks in their use of language, thereby developing confidence and resilience as **risk-takers**.

Connections to other IB Policies

Language and Admissions

SGC is committed to embracing learner diversity; however, the school enrolls only those students whose educational needs can be effectively met within its programmes. To support equitable access to learning and ensure academic success, all applicants are required to demonstrate an appropriate level of English language proficiency upon admission.

As part of the admissions process for the Diploma Programme, all prospective students are required to take an English language test prior to entry. Students with identified learning needs are provided with appropriate inclusive access arrangements for the test, such as additional time or the use of assistive technology, in accordance with their Individual Education Plan (IEP).

As English is a language of instruction at the school, students are expected to possess a strong command of English. Admission to the IB Diploma Programme generally requires English proficiency at a minimum level of B2–C1 (CEFR).



The expected English proficiency for admission to the IB Diploma Programme is B2–C1 (CEFR). In exceptional cases, applicants who demonstrate sufficient academic potential may be conditionally admitted with an agreed language-support plan. The support arrangements and review points are documented in accordance with the Admissions and Inclusion Policies.

Language and Inclusion

Differentiation in language learning is guided by best practice in accordance with the standards and practices of the International Baccalaureate. All teachers respond to diverse student needs by providing individualized support, including the use of Individual Learning Plans (ILPs) where appropriate.

In language acquisition classes, students may be grouped flexibly according to proficiency. Phases 1–2 and 3–4 may be taught within the same class where appropriate, allowing for differentiated instruction within mixed-proficiency groups. Students in Phases 5–6 engage with more advanced, near-native language use, focusing on critical analysis, nuanced expression, and academic fluency across a range of complex contexts.

Teaching strategies include flexible grouping, the use of resources with varying levels of linguistic complexity, and the adaptation of questioning and tasks. Students are also offered choice to support engagement and reflect their interests and learning preferences.

Teachers promote understanding of students' cultural identities and backgrounds, fostering an inclusive environment where diversity is respected and all learners are supported in developing language and intercultural understanding.

Language and Academic Integrity

The SGC Academic Integrity document establishes clear expectations regarding academic honesty, including definitions, practices, and consequences of academic misconduct. In alignment with the principles of the International Baccalaureate, students are expected to act as principled learners by ensuring that all submitted work reflects authentic authorship.

While academic dishonesty is defined in the general Academic Integrity policy, it may manifest in specific ways within language learning and in the use of English or other languages at SGC. The following are considered forms of academic misconduct in language contexts:



- Submitting work that is not the student's own, including work produced by another student, group, or external individual
- Using translation tools or artificial intelligence tools (including generative AI or online translators) to translate or produce text without explicit teacher authorization
- Translating reading comprehension tasks into a first language during assessment to demonstrate understanding in the target language
- Receiving unauthorized assistance from peers, parents, teachers, tutors, or any external source
- Producing written work in a student's mother tongue or strongest language and presenting it as original work in the target language of assessment

AI and translation tools may be used only when permitted by the teacher or by the requirements of the task. Any permitted use must be transparent and appropriately acknowledged and referenced. Unauthorized or undisclosed use constitutes a breach of the Academic Integrity Policy.

Language and Assessment

At SGC, the assessment of language learning is an ongoing process throughout the school year, in line with the principles of assessment for learning promoted by the International Baccalaureate. It includes both formal assessments (formative and summative) and informal learning experiences such as inquiry-based activities and classroom interactions. All four language skills—reading, writing, listening, and speaking—are assessed regularly, alongside students' understanding and accurate use of grammatical structures.

Assessment is differentiated according to students' language phase and proficiency level, and a range of formative and summative assessment strategies is employed to support learning progression.

The World Languages Department systematically collects and analyses assessment data, including teacher feedback logs, report comments, classroom observations, and samples of student work. This ongoing documentation ensures a consistent and evidence-based understanding of student progress. The information is shared among relevant teachers to support collaborative planning, informed differentiation, and inclusive teaching practices across all subjects, ensuring that language development is supported in a coherent and coordinated manner.



Contribution of all teachers to the language development of students

Teaching and learning at SGČ demonstrates that all teachers share responsibility for the language development of students, in accordance with the International Baccalaureate **Programme Standards and Practices (2020)**, particularly those relating to learning and culture. The school upholds the principle that all teachers are language teachers and actively promote communication in its various forms across the school community.

Professional learning equips teachers with strategies to support language development across the curriculum, including differentiation, scaffolding, and inclusive classroom practices that ensure access to learning for all students.

Mother Tongue

The term “*mother tongue*” refers to the language learned first and/or the language with which a student identifies as a native speaker. In the Diploma Programme, it also refers to the language used at home and/or outside the classroom. Students whose mother tongue is not the language of instruction may study it as a third language option, supporting the continued development of their first language, cognitive growth, and cultural identity.

At SGČ, the importance of students’ mother tongue is recognized and their multilingual backgrounds are valued. The school promotes additive multilingualism, ensuring that additional language learning builds on existing linguistic competence while supporting students’ cultural identity. Parents and the community are seen as key partners in supporting mother tongue development and fostering intercultural exchange.

The majority of students at SGČ are Slovak, and the school aims to support students in expanding their linguistic repertoires without diminishing their existing language skills.

IB Diploma Programme final examinations are recognized as equivalent to the Slovak *maturita* examinations by the Ministry of Education of the Slovak Republic, provided that students take the Slovak Language and Literature examination as a state graduation exam, including both written and oral components. This ensures equitable access to higher education in Slovakia and the Czech Republic.



Host Country Language – Slovak

SGČ is committed to supporting all language learning, with particular emphasis on the language of the host country. In addition to its curricular programmes, the school seeks, where possible, to provide opportunities and resources for students to further develop their Slovak language proficiency and cultural understanding.

International students may also access Slovak language courses offered by state and private language schools. These institutions provide both group instruction and individual courses tailored to students' specific linguistic needs.

Languages Pathways

Language in the IB Diploma Programme is organized into **Language and Literature (Language A)** and **Language Acquisition (Language B)** courses. Students are required to study at least two languages, one of which must be a Language A course. SGČ students can study up to three languages, depending on their proficiency and programme pathway.

Courses are offered in the language of instruction (English), the host country language (Slovak), and language acquisition courses, including German and Spanish. Course offerings are determined by student demand and class size, as well as the need to ensure continuity of learning within the IB Diploma Programme.

In addition, the IB Diploma Programme framework provides for Language A, Language B, and ab initio language study, enabling students to engage with languages at different levels of proficiency and development.

Language A

The IB **Language and Literature** courses differ in texts studied and assessed. Language and Literature includes both literary and non-literary texts, whereas Literature focuses exclusively on literary works.

Language A: Literature course develops students' skills in the critical analysis of literary texts and forms part of the IB's mother-tongue entitlement provision. At Higher Level (HL), students study 13 works, and at Standard Level (SL), 9 works, selected from a range of literary forms, periods, and contexts.

Within Language A, the School-Supported Self-Taught (SSST) option is available at Standard Level only. Students follow the course with an external tutor and are supported by the school's SSST coordinator, in accordance with IB requirements.



Language B

Language B courses offered are English, German, and Spanish. Course selection is based on linguistic progression and appropriate challenge, ensuring continued development of communicative competence rather than repetition of a language already fully mastered.

In Language B classes, the teacher may use Slovak as a language of instruction when teaching German and Spanish, where this supports clarity of explanation and access to learning. However, the target language is used progressively to ensure the development of communicative competence and immersion in the language being studied.

Online Language Options

Where a language is not offered by the school, students may undertake the course through the Pamoja Education online platform. This provision applies to both Language A and Language B courses and ensures access to a broader range of languages within the IB Diploma Programme.

There is a range of language pathways available to students, depending on their proficiency levels, interests, and future academic or career plans.

Language A	Language B	Language B (Arts)
1. English A: L&L	German SL	
2. English A: L&L	Spanish ab initio	
3. English A: L&L	German SL	Spanish ab initio
4. English A: L&L	Spanish ab initio	German B/SL
5. Slovak A Literature	English B	
6. Slovak A Literature	English B	German B/SL
7. Slovak A Literature	English B	Spanish ab initio
8. SSST	English B	
9. SSST	English B	German B/SL
10. SSST	English B	Spanish ab initio



Diploma Programme Self-Taught Languages

Where the school does not offer a student's mother tongue or strongest language as part of its regular programme, it is recommended that parents arrange for this language to be studied as an externally supported Language A through private tuition, in coordination with the Diploma Programme Coordinator.

The responsibility for appointing and remunerating the tutor lies with the parent(s). This is a private arrangement between the family and the tutor, for which the school assumes no responsibility.

Within the Diploma Programme, School-Supported Self-Taught (SSST) Language A is available at Standard Level only. The SSST option is intended for students whose Language A is not offered by the school. Students work with an external tutor and are supported by the school's SSST coordinator, in accordance with International Baccalaureate requirements.

SSST Language A: Literature (SL) is a demanding course comparable in standard to other Language A: Literature courses. Over the two-year programme, students study 10 works selected from the IB Prescribed List of Authors (PLA) and complete the Standard Level assessment components in their final year. The course forms part of Group 1 and follows the same academic expectations and assessment principles as other Diploma Programme courses.

Bilingual Diploma

A bilingual diploma is awarded to candidates who complete and achieve a grade 3 or higher in two languages. These may be selected from studies in Language and Literature, or from Language and Literature and a subject from Individuals and Societies or Sciences, provided that the two subjects are completed in different languages.

The role of library and media resources in language teaching and learning

The school library and media resources support language teaching and learning across the Diploma Programme in alignment with the principles of the International Baccalaureate. They provide equitable access to a wide range of print, digital, and multimedia resources that support the development of language proficiency.

Library resources are curated to reflect diverse cultures and levels of linguistic complexity, supporting differentiation, inquiry, and independent research.



The librarian plays an active instructional role by supporting students in locating and evaluating appropriate resources, as well as in the development of citation and referencing skills in line with academic integrity expectations.

Digital and media tools further enhance language learning by providing access to authentic language in varied contexts, supporting the development of receptive and productive skills across the curriculum.

The development of multiliteracies is supported across the curriculum through engagement with print, digital, visual, and multimedia texts. Libraries contain and manage collections of media that serve as the basis for learning and teaching multiliteracies. IB learners are not only expected to explore multiple languages, but also multiple modes of communication.

IB Standards and Practices for Language

Additional Readings

The school's language philosophy is informed by key International Baccalaureate publications, including the *Programme Standards and Practices (2020)*, the *IB Learner Profile booklet*, and *Learning in a Language Other Than Mother Tongue in IB Programmes*. These documents provide guidance on multilingual education, inclusive language practices, and the development of academic language across the curriculum.

Cycle of Review

This policy is reviewed annually and revised when required by changes in IB requirements, legislation or the school context. A comprehensive review is conducted as part of the five-year programme-evaluation cycle.

Acknowledgment

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Policy Steering Committee (2026-2027)

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